



PAPUA NEW GUINEA

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 22 JULY 2026 - 28 JULY 2026

BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

The most serious validated development in Papua New Guinea was kama sda student found dead; police investigate alleged murder on 22 July 2026. During the reporting period, violent crime and maritime events made up most of the reporting, and Morobe carried a disproportionate share of it. Reporting volume fell compared with the previous period. For operations, the immediate significance is that the lead event bears directly on staff safety and journey planning around the affected area.

TOP 3 DEVELOPMENTS

KAMA SDA STUDENT FOUND DEAD; POLICE INVESTIGATE ALLEGED MURDER:

HIGH

Homicide / violent crime · Reported 22 Jul 2026 · EMTV (PNG)

For operators, an event of this kind bears directly on staff safety and journey planning around the affected area.

PNG's East New Britain province devastated by unfolding maritime tragedy

LOW

Maritime / port · Reported 22 Jul 2026 · RNZ Pacific

For operators, an event of this kind affects port calls and sea freight through the waters or ports involved.

MOROBE POLICE INVESTIGATE WILFUL MURDER OF GOLD BUYER IN WAU-WARIA

LOW

Homicide / violent crime · Morobe · Reported 28 Jul 2026 · PNG Haus Bung

For operators, an event of this kind bears directly on staff safety and journey planning around the affected area.

INCIDENT DETAILS

OTHER OPERATIONAL DISRUPTION

Operational disruption to transport, utilities or connectivity was reported, including aviation, maritime and other security, reported across several areas without a single focus. The most serious reported was Reconnecting Rural and remote Papua New Guinea, assessed as Low severity. Reporting of this activity eased against the previous week. This reporting is most relevant to transport, power, communications and the operations that depend on them. Disruption of this kind can interrupt operations, logistics and connectivity.

Reconnecting Rural and remote Papua New Guinea

LOW

Aviation / airport · Location not specified · Reported 26 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)

Tomuriesa takes over Civil Aviation Ministry

LOW

Aviation / airport · Location not specified · Reported 25 Jul 2026 · Post-Courier (PNG)

PNG's East New Britain province devastated by unfolding maritime tragedy

LOW

Maritime / port · Location not specified · Reported 22 Jul 2026 · RNZ Pacific

PPC Baim urges people not to politicize police recruitment drive

LOW

Other security · Location not specified · Reported 22 Jul 2026 · NBC PNG

CRIME, THEFT & ROBBERY

Crime, theft and violent incidents were reported, including violent crime, concentrated in Morobe. The most serious reported was Community education and grief counselling key to end sorcery-related violence in PNG, Catholic priest says, assessed as High severity. Reporting of this activity eased against the previous week. This reporting is most relevant to staff safety, premises, vehicles and the secure movement of cash and assets. Incidents of this kind threaten staff, premises and the movement of cash and assets.

Community education and grief counselling key to end sorcery-related violence in PNG, Catholic priest says

HIGH

Homicide / violent crime · Location not specified · Reported 22 Jul 2026 · Google News - West Papua (Insurgency & Violence)

MOROBE POLICE INVESTIGATE WILFUL MURDER OF GOLD BUYER IN WAU-WARIA

LOW

Homicide / violent crime · Morobe · Reported 28 Jul 2026 · PNG Haus Bung

Indonesia-PNG Maritime Tensions: Jakarta Demands Answers Over Fisherman's Fatal Shooting

LOW

Homicide / violent crime · Location not specified · Reported 27 Jul 2026 · Google News - Papua New Guinea (Port Moresby / NCD Crime)

Indonesia Seeks Answers From Papua New Guinea Over Fisherman's Shooting

LOW

Homicide / violent crime · Location not specified · Reported 26 Jul 2026 · Google News - West Papua (Insurgency & Violence)

Indonesia seeks PNG clarification on fishing boat shooting

LOW

Homicide / violent crime · Location not specified · Reported 25 Jul 2026 · Google News - West Papua (Insurgency & Violence)

GOVERNANCE & REGULATORY

Policing, regulatory and governance-related activity was reported, including policing operation, reported across several areas without a single focus. The most serious reported was Operation 'Rausim Illegal Gambling' nets 65 arrests in WHP and Jiwaka, assessed as Moderate severity. Reporting of this activity eased against the previous week. This reporting is most relevant to permits, compliance, checkpoints and freedom of movement. Regulatory, policing and governance friction can affect compliance, permits and freedom of movement.

Operation 'Rausim Illegal Gambling' nets 65 arrests in WHP and Jiwaka

MODERATE

Policing operation · Location not specified · Reported 22 Jul 2026 · NBC PNG

CURRENT SITUATION

Security incidents in Papua New Guinea during the reporting period were concentrated in Morobe and Papua New Guinea. Violent crime and maritime were the principal concerns. Morobe generated repeat reporting within the period, so the pressure there is sustained rather than a one-off. The incidents do not currently form a single nationwide pattern; risk varies by location, and movement decisions should be based on current conditions at the destination.

OPERATIONAL IMPACT

No fresh incident-driven business impact was identified this period. Standing exposures - urban crime, Highlands tribal violence, and intermittent road, power and connectivity disruption - continue to apply.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

MOVEMENT

- Confirm current route conditions before travel into affected districts.
- Avoid non-essential after-hours movement where recent violence has occurred.

SITE SECURITY

- Review access arrangements at sites close to reported incidents.
- Confirm after-hours escalation procedures with guards and site managers.
- Check that emergency contacts and reporting lines remain current.

STAFF AWARENESS

- Reinforce immediate reporting of roadblocks, violence or police activity.

- Share only verified areas to avoid.

TRANSPORT AND LOGISTICS

- Confirm airport, port and road status before affected movements.
- Check supplier and delivery routes where disruption is reported.
- Hold alternatives for time-sensitive journeys.

OUTLOOK: NEXT SEVEN DAYS

Violent crime is likely to remain the main concern during the next seven days. Morobe saw repeat reporting within the period and is the most likely setting for renewed incidents. Reporting volume fell compared with the previous period. The coming days should be judged against that direction rather than any single event.

ESCALATION INDICATORS

- Further casualty-bearing or higher-severity violence close to staffed premises
- Spread of incidents beyond Lae / Morobe and Port Moresby / National Capital District into new districts
- Flashpoints around paydays, court rulings, election cycles and tribal-payback events

POLESTAR VIEW

Weighed together, the week's reporting bears most on both movement planning and the safety of staff and premises, and that is where checks will pay off first. On assessment, the risk is localised and varies by location, and it is best managed through location-specific decisions rather than country-wide measures. The key judgement is that violent crime drives the current concern, while other categories contributed limited, separate disruption. Businesses should prioritise verified route and site information for Morobe and Papua New Guinea over broad precautionary measures.

DISCLAIMER

Polestar Advisory Pte. Ltd. is an independent company registered in Singapore. The information in this report is based on open sources and is assessed as accurate at the time of writing. It is provided for general informational purposes only and does not constitute advice or a comprehensive assessment of all risks. No reliance should be placed on this information for operational decision-making without further independent verification.